in Muslim history. Personally, I regard it as a serious error of judgement for the modern student of the Arabic language and literature knows full well that the only non-European language which has a future is Arabic. But the reports are that the Turks have already abandoned the vernacular recitation of the Qur'an. Is it then the abolition of polygamy or the licentiate *ulama*? According to the Law of Islam, the Amir of a Muslim state has the power to revoke the 'permissions' of the law, if he is convinced that they tend to cause social corruption. As to the licentiate *ulama* I would certainly introduce it in Muslim India if I had the power to do so. The inventions of the myth-making *mulla* is largely due to the stupidity of the average Muslim. In excluding him from the religious life of the people, the Ataturk has done what would have delighted the heart of an Ibn Taimiyyah or a Shah Wali Ullah.

There is a tradition of the Holy Prophet reported in the *Mishkat* to the effect that only the Amir of the Muslim state and the person or persons appointed by him are entitled to preach to the people; I do not know whether the Ataturk ever knew of this tradition; yet it is striking how the light of his Islamic conscience has illumined the zone of his action in this important matter. The adoption of the Swiss Code with its rule of inheritance is certainly a serious error which has arisen out of the youthful zeal for reform excusable in a people furiously desiring to go ahead. The joy of emancipation from the fetters of a long-standing priestcraft sometimes drives a people to untried courses of action. But Turkey as well as the rest of the world of Islam have yet to realize the hitherto unrevealed economic aspects of the Islamic law of inheritance which Von Kremer describes as the 'supremely original branch of Muslim law'.

Is it the abolition of the Caliphate or the separation of church and state? In its essence Islam is not imperialism. In the abolition of the Caliphate which, since the days of Umayyads, had practically become a kind of empire, it is only the spirit of Islam that has worked out through the Ataturk. In order to understand the Turkish Ijtihad in the matter of the Caliphate we cannot but seek the guidance of Ibn Khaldun, the great philosophical historian of Islam and the father of modern history. I can do